

microscopic Description of something that can only be seen clearly by humans with the help of a microscope

migration Long journey made by animals to find a new place to feed or raise their families. Many animals migrate every year between their summer and winter homes

mineral Solid material made of chemical elements. When different minerals are mixed together, they create rock

mollusc Type of invertebrate with a soft body and sometimes a shell, including octopuses, clams, and snails

myth Story or tale

nectar Sweet, sugary liquid made by flowers. Insects, birds, and mammals visit the flowers to drink the nectar

organic Made by a living thing

organism Any living thing, such as a plant, animal, fungus, alga, or bacterium

oxygen Invisible gas that animals, including humans, need to breathe. It is released by algae and plants, and is one of the main gases in air. It also dissolves in water

parasite Organism that lives on or in another host organism, and causes it harm. Parasites feed on their host and cannot live without it. Examples of parasites include mosquitoes, vampire bats, some flatworms, and corpse flowers

photosynthesis Chemical process by which plants and algae make their own food using the energy from sunlight. As they do this, they release oxygen gas

plankton Tiny living things that drift in oceans and lakes, and which are often too small for us to see. They include algae and small animals, such as shrimp and copepods

poison Harmful substance made as a defence. Poison made by animals is often found in their skin. An attacker is poisoned if it touches or eats the poisonous organism

pollen Dust-like grains made by flowers and the cones of conifer trees. Pollen spreads on the wind, or with the help of animals. When pollen is moved from flower to flower, or cone to cone, it makes the flower or cone produce seeds

pollination Moving pollen between plants so they can make seeds. Pollen is usually moved by wind or by animals known as pollinators

predator Animal that hunts another animal, called prey, for food

prehistoric From a very time long ago. Many prehistoric animals and plants no longer exist, but we know about them from fossils

prey Animal that is hunted by a predator

rainforest Forest habitat where it is very wet and rains a lot. The largest rainforests are in the world's hot, tropical areas, and their trees can be very tall. They are home to huge numbers of different plants and animals

reptile Animal with a backbone that has tough skin, is covered in hard scales, and usually lays eggs. Reptiles include snakes, lizards, turtles, and crocodiles

resin Thick yellow, brown, or red liquid produced by trees. It oozes out of cuts in bark to help the wound close

rock Hard solid made from minerals

sap Sugary liquid produced by plants. It moves around inside stems and branches, a bit like blood in animals

seaweed Type of large alga that grows in the ocean. Seaweeds photosynthesise like plants

sedimentary rock Rock made when sand, gravel, and other pieces of rock pile up and are squashed together

species Particular type of animal, plant, or other living thing. For example, the lion and cheetah are different species of cat. Members of the same species can breed together to produce young, but they usually cannot breed with other species

spore Dust-like grains released by ferns, mosses, and fungi, which will grow into a new organism

ultraviolet light Type of light invisible to us, but which can be seen by some other animals. Some minerals glow under ultraviolet (UV) light. UV light is what makes human skin tan, and unless we protect ourselves it can cause sunburn

vein Long tube or pipe that carries liquid in an animal or plant. In animals, veins carry blood. Plant veins transport water and sugar

venom Harmful liquid made by an animal. Venom is different from poison, because it is delivered by stingers or a bite into prey or an attacker's body